Assisted video production: visual editing, modular stages and measured costs

Strengths and best use

A modular editing pipeline separates understanding footage, deciding edits, rendering, and publishing. Timestamped transcripts help locate speech; visual composites reveal framing and scene content; declarative edits make decisions reproducible. Components can be replaced and measured independently. video-use (https://github.com/browser-use/video-use) - Editly (https://github.com/mifi/editly) - FFmpeg (https://ffmpeg.org/documentation.html)

Assemble the smallest useful stack

Start with one owned recording and one short output. video-use's current README describes ElevenLabs Scribe transcription plus on-demand visual composites. It is therefore more than a transcript parser, and the external transcription service has its own configuration and cost. Use the repository's current setup guide for FFmpeg, uv, and required credentials. Its dependency setup begins:

```
git clone https://github.com/browser-use/video-use.git
cd video-use
uv sync
```

Store timestamps, speaker text, visual observations, proposed cuts, and reasons separately. Review visual changes around every cut; transcript coherence alone cannot catch an obstructed face, an important gesture, or text that vanishes too quickly. Editly can express an edit; HyperFrames or Remotion can supply authored graphics. Choose a renderer based on the actual deliverable. HyperFrames (https://github.com/heygen-com/hyperframes) - Remotion (https://www.remotion.dev/)

Check current costs and permissions

The reels' quoted monthly bundle is a scenario, not a verified complete price. Itemize the model subscription or API, transcription, generated media, stock assets, render compute, retries, and human review. Remotion's free license covers eligible individuals and teams up to three, with separate conditions for companies. Inspect the current terms for the intended organization. Remotion license (https://www.remotion.dev/docs/license/faq) - Claude pricing (https://claude.com/pricing)

Optional discovery and distribution services introduce separate usage bills. Compare Apify tasks and Resend email volume against current plans only if the pipeline needs them. A current Higgsfield price could not be established from the fetched page; retain that value as unknown until checked directly. Apify (https://apify.com/pricing) - Resend (https://resend.com/pricing)

Validate before distribution

Version the source, edit decisions, asset provenance, and export settings. Review captions, audio, aspect ratio, licensing, and every generated factual claim. Keep publishing as a separate reviewed stage. Record

unsuccessful exports and manual correction time alongside accepted outputs; those costs explain whether automation helps.

Reusable prompt

```
Design a replaceable pipeline for this owned recording. Produce timestamped transcript and visual observations, a justified cut list, and one short draft. For each stage record provider, inputs, outputs, cost, retries, failure behavior, and review. Check media rights and render licensing, then wait for review before distribution.
```

Project idea

Build a mock-job dashboard that reconciles transcript and visual review, render status, provider costs, and accepted deliverables. Compare a manual edit and an assisted edit using all labor time.

Original sources

- https://www.instagram.com/reel/DfYBF8ySvpx/
- https://www.instagram.com/reel/DfXEszMtPbu/